

Complete Guide to shadcn/ui

What is shadcn/ui?

shadcn/ui is a modern, open-source collection of **beautifully designed, accessible components** built with:

- React
- Tailwind CSS
- Radix UI (for accessibility and headless UI logic)
- TypeScript

Unlike a traditional component library (like Material UI), **shadcn/ui** lets you **copy and own the components**. You get full control over styling and behavior.

Why Use shadcn/ui?

Feature	Description
Design	Clean, modern look following best design practices
Customizable	You're encouraged to copy and fully own the code
Accessible	Built with Radix UI primitives for accessibility
Type-safe	Uses TypeScript for all components
Utility-first styling	Uses Tailwind CSS for all styling
Framework-friendly	Works great with Next.js, Vite, Create React App, etc.

🔧 Installation

To set up `shadcn/ui` in your project:

1. Install Tailwind CSS (if not already installed)

```
npx create-next-app@latest my-app --typescript
cd my-app
npm install -D tailwindcss postcss autoprefixer
npx tailwindcss init -p
```

2. Configure Tailwind in `tailwind.config.ts`

```
/** @type {import('tailwindcss').Config} */
module.exports = {
  content: [
    './app/**/*.ts,tsx',
    './pages/**/*.ts,tsx',
    './components/**/*.ts,tsx',
  ],
  theme: {
    extend: {},
  },
  plugins: [],
};
```

3. Install shadcn/ui CLI

```
npx shadcn-ui@latest init
```

It will ask you questions like: - Which framework (Next.js, etc.)? - Where to put components? - Do you want to use dark mode?

4. Add a component

```
npx shadcn-ui@latest add button
```

This will generate a fully customizable Button component in your project.

How It Works

- **Components are copied** into your `components/ui` folder.
- **No dependency on external styles or packages.** You own the code.
- Uses **Tailwind CSS classes** for styling.
- Built on top of **Radix UI**, which provides unstyled, accessible primitives (like Dialog, Popover, etc.)
- All components are written in **TypeScript**.

Common Components

You can generate and customize: - `button` - `dialog` - `input` - `dropdown-menu` - `popover` - `tabs` - `tooltip` - `card` - And many more...

Dark Mode

shadcn/ui supports dark mode out of the box using Tailwind's `dark` class. You can enable it during setup or tweak later in your Tailwind config.

Tips

- **Tailor the components to your project.** You don't need to stick to the default styles.
 - **Use TypeScript** for full intellisense and type safety.
 - Combine with **Framer Motion** or other tools for animations.
 - Add your own utility classes or base styles.
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Resources

- GitHub: <https://github.com/shadcn-ui/ui>
 - Docs: <https://ui.shadcn.com>
 - Radix UI: <https://www.radix-ui.com/>
 - Tailwind CSS: <https://tailwindcss.com>
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Summary

Feature	shadcn/ui
Styling	Tailwind
Accessibility	Yes
Customization	100%
Frameworks	React-based (Next.js, CRA, etc.)
Dark mode	Built-in support

shadcn/ui = Your components, your control, with a beautiful starting point.